

RHYTHM FM 94.7

30th Anniversary Documentary Series -- Project Brief

Prepared by: Asha Gallegos and Sipho Ndaba

Date: 10 February 2026

Submitted to: Dr. Nomsa Khumalo, Station Manager

OVERVIEW

Rhythm FM 94.7 turns 30 in November 2026. To mark this milestone, the morning show team proposes a three-part documentary series exploring the station's history, its role in the Johannesburg cultural landscape, and the voices that shaped it. Each part will air in the week of the anniversary and will be available on the station's podcast platform from the same date.

SERIES STRUCTURE

Part 1 -- The Signal Goes Out: Radio before and after 1994. How community radio and commercial stations navigated the post-apartheid transition. Key interviewees: Kgosi Media Group founders, archive staff, and two veteran presenters from the station's early years. Broadcast date: 9 November 2026.

Part 2 -- The City Through the Speakers: Three decades of Johannesburg as heard on Rhythm FM. Listener testimonials, archival clips, and a conversation with music director Mandla Sithole on how the playlist shifted. Broadcast date: 16 November 2026.

Part 3 -- Morning Drive: What it means to be the first voice someone hears each day. An intimate look at the show team, the preparation, and the responsibility of speaking into so many mornings. Broadcast date: 23 November 2026.

ARCHIVE ACCESS REQUIRED

Asha and Sipho will need access to the station archive from January 2026, including broadcast recordings from 1996, 2001, 2010, and 2019. Archive contact: Thandi Simelane, Reference: KMG-ARCH-2026-003.

PRODUCTION TEAM

Lead presenter and writer: Asha Gallegos

Producer: Sipho Ndaba

Sound engineer: Naledi Tau

Music supervision: Mandla Sithole (consulting)

TIMELINE

Research and interviews: October 2026

Editing: October 2026

Final review with station manager: late October 2026

Broadcast: November 2026 (three Mondays)

BUDGET NOTE

A separate budget request for archive licensing and external interview travel has been submitted to the finance desk. Estimated cost: ZAR 28,000 for the full series.